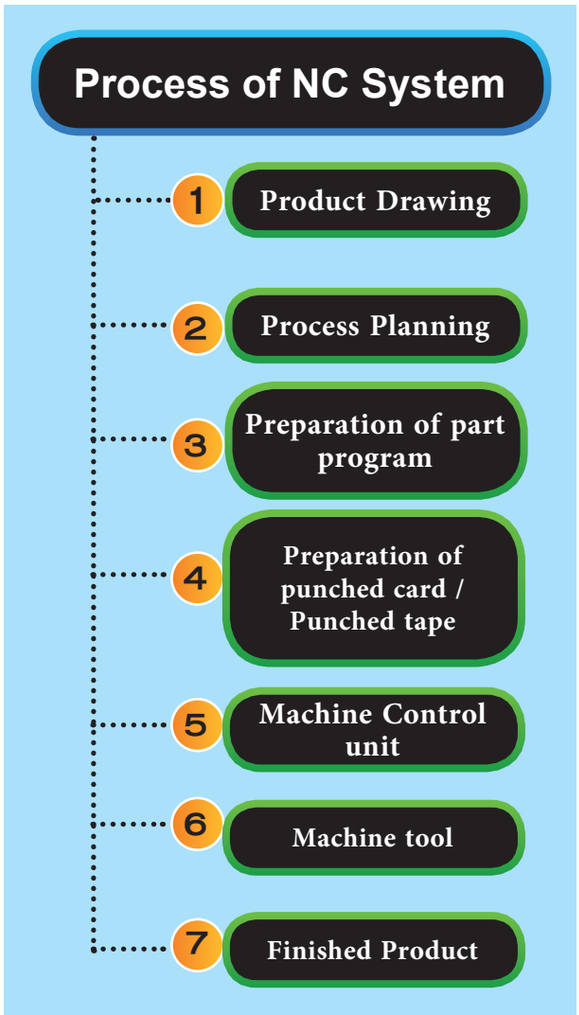


9.5 Software

Software of a NC system can be referred to items comprising of instructions, (programs) computer languages used for write these programs and a variety of input media.

In order to provide informations into the control unit or a computer, binary format is used. In this system, only two digits 0 and 1 are used.

9.6 Input Media

Different types of input media are used to store informations and to provide input to various control units of the NC machine. They are

1. Punched cards
2. Punched tapes
3. Magnetic tapes
4. Floppy disks

Punched cards and punched tapes are useful in storing data in the form a series of punched holes. Punched tapes may be made of paper, plastic or aluminium foils. Magnetic tapes are made of plastic material and coated with Gamma ferric oxide layer. Magnetic tapes may be used for storing more informations and it may erased and reused.

9.7 Machine Control Unit (MCU)

Machine Control Unit consists of electronic circuits (hardware) that are useful in reading and interpreting the instructions (NC program) fed by means of input media and convert them into mechanical actions of the machine tool.

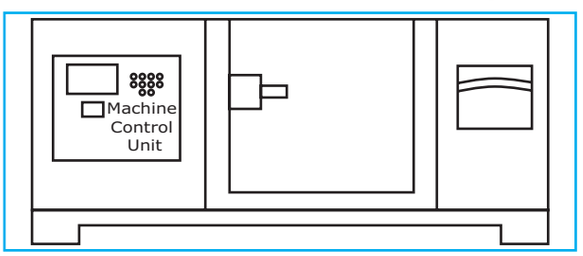
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There are three types of MCU. They are

A. Inbuilt type
B. Swivel type
C. Stand alone type

A. Inbuilt MCU

When the control unit of the NC machine is mounted in the construction of the machine itself, it is known as Inbuilt MCU. Inbuilt MCU is shown in figure.



Inbuilt MCU

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